

Word family: **coat / coats / coated / coating**

Base word: coat

Forms: coats, coated, coating

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...when the weather is slightly cool but not cold enough for a heavy **coat**."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **coat** means a **warm outer garment worn over other clothes, usually longer and heavier than a jacket**.

繁體中文： **大衣；外套；通常比 jacket 更長、更厚，用來保暖的外層衣物**

中文翻譯：

> "...not cold enough for a heavy **coat**."

「.....但又未冷到需要穿厚**大衣 / 外套**。」

Here:

heavy coat = 厚身、保暖的大衣

1. **coat = outer garment worn for warmth/protection (衣服) — 大衣；外套**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: An outer piece of clothing worn over other clothes, usually for warmth or protection.

Practice 1 — Original

> "It was not cold enough for a heavy **coat**."

「天氣還沒有冷到需要穿厚**大衣**。」

Practice 2

> "She put on her **coat** before going outside."

「她出門前穿上了**外套**。」

Practice 3

> “His winter **coat** is extremely warm.”

「他的冬季**大衣**非常保暖。」

coat = 穿在其他衣服外面的保暖或防護性外衣，通常比 jacket 較長、較厚

Common:

* winter coat

* wool coat

* raincoat

* overcoat

* heavy coat

2. **coat** = natural covering of hair/fur on an animal (動物) — 毛皮；體毛

Coat can mean the layer of hair or fur covering an animal's body.

Practice 4

> “The dog has a thick **coat**.”

「這隻狗有一層很厚的**毛皮**。」

Practice 5

> “The horse's **coat** looked healthy and shiny.”

「那匹馬的**毛色 / 毛皮**看起來健康而有光澤。」

coat = 動物身體表面自然生長的一層毛髮或毛皮

Common:

* thick coat

* winter coat

* glossy coat

* coat colour

This is a genuinely distinct noun meaning.

3. **coat** = layer covering a surface (表層) — 一層；塗層；覆蓋層

Coat can mean a layer of material spread over or covering a surface.

Practice 6

> “The wall needs another **coat** of paint.”

「這面牆需要再上一層油漆。」

Practice 7

> “A thin **coat** of dust covered the shelf.”

「架子上覆蓋着一薄層灰塵。」

Practice 8

> “The cake has a **coat** of chocolate.”

「這個蛋糕外面有一層朱古力。」

coat = 覆蓋在某物表面上的一層物質

Common:

* coat of paint

* coat of varnish

* coat of dust

* coat of chocolate

This is a major distinct sense.

4. **coat** = protective outer layer of a biological structure (生物) — 外膜；外皮；包膜

In biology and botany, **coat** can refer to an outer protective layer.

Practice 9

> “The seed has a hard outer **coat**.”

「種子有一層堅硬的外皮 / 種皮。」

Practice 10

> “The capsule has a protective **coat**.”

「膠囊有一層保護**外膜**。」

coat = 生物結構外圍具有保護作用的外層

Examples:

* seed coat

* protein coat

* outer coat

For strict counting, this belongs under Meaning 3: **outer covering/layer**.

5. **coat** = verb: cover something with a layer (動詞) — 覆蓋；塗上一層

As a verb, **coat** means to cover the surface of something with a layer of another material.

Practice 11

> “They **coated** the walls with paint.”

「他們在牆上**塗**了一層**油漆**。」

Practice 12

> “The road was **coated** with ice.”

「道路表面**覆蓋**着一層**冰**。」

coat something with something = 在某物表面覆蓋一層材料

Common:

* coat with paint

* coat with wax

* coat with oil

* coat with ice

* coat with dust

This is the verb counterpart of Meaning 3.

6. **coat = verb: cover food with an ingredient (烹飪) — 裹上 ; 沾上一層**

A very common culinary use:

Practice 13

> “**Coat** the chicken in flour.”

「把雞肉**裹上一層**麵粉。」

Practice 14

> “The cookies were **coated** in chocolate.”

「曲奇外面**裹着一層**朱古力。」

coat food = 把食物表面均勻裹上一層麵粉、醬汁、朱古力等

For core counting, this belongs under the general verb “cover with a layer.”

7. **coat = verb: become covered over a surface (覆滿) — 覆蓋 ; 附着**

Sometimes the subject doing the coating is a substance.

Practice 15

> “Dust **coated** the furniture.”

「灰塵**覆蓋了**家具表面。」

Practice 16

> “A layer of frost **coated** the windows.”

「窗戶上**覆着**一層霜。」

This is still the same surface-covering concept, but grammatically useful.

8. **coating = layer applied to a surface (塗層) — 塗層 ; 包覆層**

****Coating**** is an important related noun.

Practice 17

> “The pan has a non-stick ****coating****.”

「這個煎鍋有一層防黏****塗層****。」

Practice 18

> “The tablet has a protective ****coating****.”

「這顆藥片有一層保護****包衣****。」

****coating** = 為保護、裝飾、改善功能等而覆在表面的一層材料******

Common:

- * protective coating
- * waterproof coating
- * non-stick coating
- * chocolate coating

9. ****coated** = covered with a layer (被覆蓋的) — 有塗層的；裹着的******

Practice 19

> “The metal is ****coated**** with zinc.”

「金屬表面****鍍 / 覆有****一層鋅。」

Practice 20

> “She bought chocolate-****coated**** biscuits.”

「她買了朱古力****包裹的****餅乾。」

****coated** = 表面被另一種物質覆蓋的******

10. ****coat of arms** = heraldic emblem (固定詞組) — 徽章；紋章******

This is an important lexicalized expression.

A **coat of arms** is a heraldic design associated with a family, institution, city, country, etc.

Practice 21

> “The city’s **coat of arms** appears on the flag.”

「城市的**紋章**出現在旗幟上。」

Practice 22

> “The family used an old **coat of arms**.”

「這個家族使用一個古老的**家族紋章**。」

coat of arms = 代表家族、城市、機構等的傳統紋章圖案

This should be stored as a **fixed lexical expression**, not interpreted literally as a piece of clothing.

11. **white coat** = doctor/scientist by association (轉喻複合) — 白袍 ; 醫護 / 科研形象

In compounds and expressions, **coat** can stand metonymically for a profession associated with a particular coat.

For example:

* white coat

* lab coat

A **white coat** literally means the garment, but can sometimes evoke doctors, scientists, or clinical settings.

This is better treated as a **compound/contextual metonymy**, not a separate core sense of **coat**.

Important distinction: **coat vs jacket**

This matters directly in your passage.

jacket

usually:

- * shorter
- * lighter
- * ends around waist or hips

coat

usually:

- * longer
- * heavier
- * more strongly associated with warmth/weather protection

Compare:

- > denim jacket
- > winter coat

There is overlap, but **coat** usually suggests heavier outerwear.

Important distinction: **coat vs overcoat**

overcoat

is specifically a long, heavy coat worn over ordinary clothes.

coat

is the broader category.

So:

- > every overcoat is a coat
- > not every coat is an overcoat

Important distinction: **coat vs layer**

layer

is the general term for any thickness of material lying over/under another.

coat

usually implies a layer covering the surface.

- > layer of soil
- > coat of paint

A coat is generally an outer layer.

Important distinction: **coat vs covering**

covering

is broad and can be any material over something.

coat

often suggests a relatively thin or continuous surface layer.

- > protective covering
- > coat of varnish

Important distinction: **coat vs coating**

coat

can mean one application/layer:

- > two coats of paint

coating

often means the material or continuous layer itself:

- > protective coating

So:

- > apply two coats
- > add a protective coating

Important distinction: **coat** vs **paint**

paint

is the substance.

coat

is one layer/application of that substance.

> a can of paint

> two coats of paint

Grammar note: **coat** something with / be coated in

Two major patterns:

coat something with X

> “Coat the bread with butter.”

「在麵包表面塗上一層牛油。」

be coated in/with X

> “The road was coated in ice.”

「道路被冰層覆蓋。」

Both **in** and **with** occur depending on context.

Countability note

Coat is countable in both major noun branches.

Clothing

> a coat

> three coats

Applied layer

- > one coat of paint
- > two coats of varnish

Animal covering

Usually singular for one animal:

- > “The dog has a thick coat.”

Useful collocations

Clothing

- * heavy coat
- * winter coat
- * wool coat
- * raincoat
- * overcoat

Animal

- * thick coat
- * glossy coat
- * winter coat

Surface layer

- * coat of paint
- * coat of varnish
- * coat of wax

Verb

- * coat with flour
- * coat in chocolate
- * coated surface

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **coat**
 * **coats**
 * **coated**
 * **coating**

Useful compounds/fixed forms:

* raincoat
 * overcoat
 * lab coat
 * coat of paint
 * seed coat
 * coat of arms

The word's semantic system is built around a strong common image:

> **an outer covering surrounding or lying over something**

That produces:

* clothing around a person
 * fur around an animal
 * paint/dust/wax over a surface
 * protective biological layers
 * verb "cover with a layer"

However, **coat of arms** has become lexicalized enough that it must be treated separately as a fixed expression.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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coat — clothing	穿在其他衣服外面的較長 / 較厚外衣，主要用來保暖或防護
coat — animal	覆蓋動物身體的天然毛髮 / 毛皮
coat — surface layer	覆蓋在物體表面的一層物質
coat — biological covering	種子、細胞等外面的保護層；屬於 outer-layer 義
coat — verb	在某物表面覆蓋 / 塗上一層材料
coat food	把食物表面裹上一層麵粉、醬料、朱古力等
coating	覆在物件表面的塗層 / 包覆層
coated	表面被一層物質覆蓋的
coat of arms	家族、城市、機構等使用的紋章；固定詞組

For your original sentence

> "...not cold enough for a heavy **coat**."

The exact meaning is:

coat = 穿在其他衣服外面、主要用來保暖的較厚外套

So:

> **heavy coat**

= **厚大衣 / 保暖厚外套**

For your database, I would count **3** genuinely useful core meanings for **coat**:

1. **outer garment**
2. **animal's natural fur/hair covering**
3. **a layer covering a surface**

The verb **coat** = cover with a layer belongs directly to #3. I would merge **paint, dust, chocolate, seed coat, protective coating** contexts under that outer-layer concept rather than split them by material or domain, while keeping **coat of arms** as a separate fixed lexical expression.